ATHAN STEFANOS

Graduate Aerospace Engineer

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EDUCATION

Monash University - Bachelor of Aerospace Engineering (Honours), Artificial Intelligence Minor

EXPERIENCE

Monash High Powered Rocketry | Aerostructures Engineer, Flight Systems Engineer

2022-2026 • Sounding Rocket Student Team

- Engineered composite rocket airframes and high altitude recovery system hardware from design through to implementation.
- Gained strong skills in CAD design, FEA for isotropic and anisotropic materials, CFD, design iterating, and report writing.
- Followed systems engineering frameworks, collaborating and designing across multiple sections of the team.

Jetstar Engineering Internship | Fleet Development Engineer

2025-2026 Summer • Commercial Airliner

- Assisted in implementing and managing an upgrade program for the Boeing 787 relating to the structural modification of an aircraft to house a satellite connectivity system.
- Gained experience in regulatory framework for commercial aircraft and created proposals for CASA.
- Used data and trend analysis skills with large aviation datasets to give insights into performance.
- Sought out stakeholders and negotiated deliverables for the benefit of all parties.

Pennywise Peripherals | Cinema Automation Assembler & Tester

2026 • Electrical Engineering Company

- Worked within an engineering company with the responsibility of assembling, troubleshooting, and testing cinema automation units.
- Identified and implemented solutions to manufacturing line problems and experienced ‘the final push’.

Monash Motorsport Industry Skills Course

2025 • Metal Machining Course

- Honed my skills in the manual lathe, mill, and engineering measurement tools.
- Gained valuable insight into workshop processes that improved my designing skills for manufacturing.

SELECTED PROJECTS

High Altitude Recovery Parachute Design | Project Daybreak - Monash High Powered Rocketry

2026 • 100,000 ft Parachute system design for the Friends of Amateur Rocketry Competition

- Executed preliminary research, detailed design, and CFD simulation of a novel high altitude rocket recovery parachute.
- Tailored the parachute design to competition requirements resulting in a 827 gram weight and 22 m/s descent rate.
- Regularly communicated with project leadership to guide design iterations.

Recovery Hardware Bay | Project Meridian - Monash High Powered Rocketry

2025 • 10,000 ft Bay design for the Australian Universities Rocketry Competition

- Designed, FEA-validated and manufactured a carbon-fibre/fibreglass recovery bay for a 10,000-ft sounding rocket, integrating structural, recovery and avionics interfaces.
- Managed launch-day integration and checklists to adaptively solve problems.
- Successfully flew the hardware bay, withstanding up to 20 g’s of acceleration.

Aircraft Design Project | Stick Bug - 180 PAX Passenger Jet Design

2025 • Group project for fourth year Flight Vehicle Design class

- Lead a team of 10 engineering students to design a passenger jet with a harmonic range of 8000 km.
- Conducted aerodynamic analysis to optimise drag and ensure control stability.
- Exercised clear and strong communication within the group and adaptively managed requirements across aircraft components.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

CAD - SolidWorks, Creo Parametric **Analysis** - ANSYS, Abaqus, OpenVSP **Programming** - MATLAB, Python, C++

Manufacturing - Wet layups, resin infusions, manual machining, GD&T, engineering drawings

References available on request